



Fruits and seeds



Different seeds

Seeds come in all shapes and sizes. They are protected in many different ways.

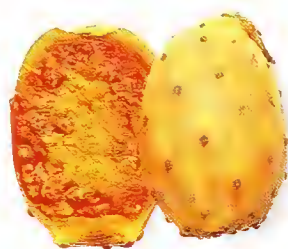


Acorns are the fruit of the oak tree. Fruits that have hard, woody shells are called nuts.

Sycamore seeds grow inside a seed case that is wing-shaped.



Prickly pear seeds grow inside a thick, spiky-skinned fruit.



We think of fruits as juicy foods, like peaches and grapes. But fruits are really seed cases, and they certainly can't all be eaten!



Peas are seeds. They grow inside a fruit called a pea pod.



Dates are the fruits of palm trees. Each date contains one seed.

Lemon seeds are called pips. They are protected by a fruit with juicy flesh and a tough skin.



Making seeds

1 As soon as a flower is pollinated, it starts to grow seeds.



2 The petals drop off, leaving just a seed case.

3 As the seeds grow, the seed case grows bigger, too. This is the fruit.



Spreading seeds

Seeds need to get away from their parent plant so that they will have plenty of room to grow.

Dandelion seeds float through the air on fluffy parachutes.



Prickly burrs stick to animals' coats and are carried away.



Berries are eaten by birds, which leave the seeds in their droppings.



Walkers carry seeds around in the mud on their boots.



4 The fruit ripens at the same time as the seeds inside.

Did you know?

The world's largest seed is from the coco de la mer palm tree. It can weigh as much as 44 lb (20 kg).



Coconuts float out to sea and are washed up on other beaches.

